

EPISODE 20 (SESSION 1)

With All Your Heart

PRIMARY TEXT: EXODUS 14–16

Wandering through the desert. One day. Two days. One week. One month. One year.

The sun baking and blistering your skin. Heat driving you both forward and closer to the ground. Chapped, cracking lips, and you begin to taste the blood. The light reflecting off the desert floor, blinding you as you walk. Carrying or nudging your children along as they cry from the heat and their scraped knees. The sweat dripping from your brow, wondering how everyone will stay hydrated. Helping the elderly and lame stumble through the sandy dirt. *Almost there. Keep going.* Miracles begin to be a distant memory in the midst of this new, harsh reality. No bush large enough for all God's children to rest under as Hagar did with Ishmael. No promised land yet in sight.

No promised land yet in sight. Just the promise—and the waiting.

Just the promise—and the waiting.

Imagine the weight of this on Israel's hearts. Hearts already weakened or bitterly hardened to keep them safe, or just alive, after decades of oppression.

Just a bit of shade, please...

Our children can't do this for much longer... What were we thinking... ?

At least there was a place to rest—at the end of the day—in Egypt...

I'd take the swift crack of a whip over this...

Remember when we sat around pots of meat and food? We are likely to starve!

If only we had died swiftly by the Lord's hand in Egypt!

God, just give us a sign!

How would it weigh on our own?

I doubt our words today would be much different, even after seeing miracle after miracle.

... community—the intertwining of all their hearts in intimacy with God.

Yet, there's a stark contrast between the journey of the Israelites and many of us who doubt in isolation during our desert-like moments today.

Their community—the intertwining of all their hearts in intimacy with God.

"With all your heart" isn't just the one individual heart against a lost world. It's also communal.

To love God with all your heart in the story of the Exodus was shown through the lens of the people of Israel as one—it wasn't just one test of Moses or Miriam that then checked the list off for God. God wanted to see and intimately know *all* of His people.

Through these “tests” in the desert, God wanted to know them—and for them to know Him. To wander alongside them and to see what they learned. To teach them and prepare them for where to go next. Showing them that radical hospitality of their forefather through lessons of caring for the marginalized and the outcast, and to trust, with all of their heart, that there will be enough.

What does “all your heart” look like in community?

It looks like the strong and powerful gathering food and water for the weak before themselves. It looks like a party. A celebration of song and joy and hope filled with laughter and promises of goodness.

**What does “all
your heart” look
like in community?**

It looks like an active God, moving within and with His people. It looks like all people calling Him Lord, praising Him while in the desert or in the land of promise. It looks like obedience. Recognizing that we may not understand the why, but we know that if we just wait, sometimes just a little bit longer, there will be more than enough.

It looks like the Kingdom. Revealed and restored on earth as it always should have been—in community, and with all that our hearts can muster.

PRAYER

We sing to You Lord, for You are highly exalted.

*May you move around us and within us
as we lift up Your name and call You Lord
of all the earth and everything in it.*

*May we respond in obedience—
even when we don't understand—
that we may show you what lies in our hearts
and learn and grow in You.*

*May we never stop trusting and loving You
with all our heart.*

*May we continue to choose every day
to be and bring and reveal
Your Kingdom on Earth.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 20

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What might be important to meditate over from Exodus 14–16? What Text could you continue to meditate on, memorize, or dig deeper into? What resonates with your heart and mind?



COMMUNITY

How does your community follow God with all your heart? What lies in the heart of your community? How might you show what you have learned through your own deserts?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from a mentor-like relationship, showing what you have learned from God during your own deserts? Who might God be leading you towards bringing into your community to not wander alone? How do you do or show this purposefully now?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with? What is unsettling or confusing? The idea of being tested? The doubt? The significance of the 12 springs and 70 palm trees? Bitterness? What could you study more deeply? Remember—wrestling is good! (Especially in community.)



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*What spiritual practices or disciplines might you need to connect with God? We believe that **if we do our part in creating space for God, He will fill it.** How might the smallest practice make you readily available to God—to give Him all your heart and show Him all you’ve learned so He can reveal and teach you more? How have you created a space to hear God speak to you? Spiritual disciplines and opportunities for Him to really know you, and you likewise to know God.*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

***We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world,** and they need to be shown by people just like you what it looks like to wander in the desert. To show how to give God all your heart, individually and as God’s family, and that there truly are growing pains in this. Young adults are world-changers, open to Jesus—they just need people to show them that this intimacy is good, not a trap. What young adults might you be able to invite into this journey?*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Being part of God’s Kingdom, giving Him all your heart, isn’t just for Sunday mornings or Bible study; this is about what we do in our everyday lives. How might you put the character of God on display in how you pursue and experience your 9–5? Does our physical work put the marginalized—the alien, orphan, and widow—before ourselves? Do we create space to put the love of God and His call to love others on display? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products should bless others. Even God! **You are doing a sacred work—no matter where you are. Do it with all your heart.***